Have you heard of transpiration?

It is the process of loss of water from the aerial parts of a plant in vapour form.

There is a continuous cycling of water and it exists in three forms in nature.

Water evaporating from lakes, rivers and oceans forms the gaseous state. Rain water forms the liquid state. Snow on mountains and polar ice caps forms the solid state.

These three states occur in nature, keep the total amount of water on the earth constant even when the whole world is using it!

How do you know that atmosphere has water vapour?

Let us do the following activity...

Activity 5: Condensation of water vapour.

Take a glass half filled with water. Wipe the outer surface of the glass with a clean piece of cloth. Add some ice into the water. Wait for one or two minutes. Observe the changes that take place on the outer surface of the glass.

From where do water drops appear on the outer side of the glass?

The cold surface of the glass containing icy water cools the air around it and the water vapour of the air condenses on the surface of the glass. This process is also the result of condensation of water vapour.

2.6 Natural Sources of fresh water

Three types of natural sources of fresh water are available on the earth.

Surface water



Water present on the surface of the earth such as river,lake,ponds, streams or fresh water wetland is called surface water.

Frozen water



Water that is present in the frozen form as polar ice-caps and glaciers are called frozen water. A larger portion of water is 68.7% of the total available fresh water is in frozen state.

Ground water

Ground water is the water present beneath Earth's surface in soil. This water is

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